

JOSEPH POINTER

Directing a Standing AI Agent Team Since 2024 | AI Adoption at Scale | Champion Networks,
Enablement & Recognition

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1,500+ REACHED DIRECTLY IN SESSIONS I LED	7 BUSINESS AREAS ON ONE OPERATING MODEL	9 MODULE AI PLATFORM, IDEA TO COMPANY-WIDE	Since 2024 DIRECTING A STANDING AI AGENT TEAM
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PROFILE

Since 2024 I have directed a standing team of AI agents that stops my own work when it overclaims. I configure them without code and run them daily from the command line. Separately, I led the human side of adoption for the AI platform I conceived and launched at a Fortune 100 firm.

Twenty-five years in transformation, change, and capability work, the last fifteen leading it inside a Fortune 100 regulated financial services firm. At TIAA I conceived, designed, and launched a 9-module AI-powered career development platform and owned it from the first discovery conversation through governance, phased rollout, and measured use, then built and ran the champion network and the enablement behind it. I am not an engineer. I direct AI builds, and two products I conceived and co-founded are live today.

THE AI AGENT TEAM I RUN

- **A standing team with defined responsibilities and named gates:** Each agent owns a role, enforces its own rules, has a boundary it does not cross, and runs on the model its job actually needs. An adversarial reviewer attacks any claim that cannot be defended. A voice reviewer rejects work that stops sounding like me. I configure them without writing code and direct them daily in Claude Code at the command line.
- **How I manage them:** Before I changed which model each agent runs on, I wrote down what degradation would look like for each one and set a revert-first rule, so the failure criteria existed before the change did. A weak gate costs a public mistake. A weak suggestion costs an edit.
- **What the gates have caught:** Three overclaims on their way into a live application, including a metric that had already cleared several review passes. They have also missed one, which reached a live profile before I caught it myself. I run the team because I am the one accountable when it is wrong.
- **Agent architecture inside a shipped product:** TheHotSeat, a four-agent interview simulator inside CareerPointers (careerpointers.org), runs a job analyst, a question designer, live interviewer reactions, and a feedback coach across eight panel presets. I designed its delegation and prompt architecture.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Director, Business Management

February 2022 - July 2026

TIAA (Fortune 100 Financial Services, \$1.5T AUM)

Business Manager (2016-2022) | Senior Business Management Specialist, internal Lean consultant (2013-2016) | Business Consultant (2011-2013)

Owned org-wide programs inside a 3,000-associate organization at a Fortune 100 firm. Ran one operating model across seven business areas, none of which reported to me, and owned the executive read-outs and quarterly business reviews where the trade-offs were decided.

AI Adoption, Discovery Through Measured Use

- **Took an AI platform from idea to company-wide launch:** Ran discovery with business teams, scoped and sequenced use cases by impact, decided what shipped in each phase, and owned governance, rollout, and measurement. Built for a transformation population first, then released company-wide with 16,000+ associates given access.

- **Ran 30+ workshops, demonstrations, town halls, and team sessions myself:** Each one built around work people already cared about rather than a tour of the technology. The objection was rarely the tool. It was people protecting the part of the job that made them feel valuable.
- **Shipped the adoption layer with the product:** Prompt guidance and role-based materials went out alongside the platform rather than leaving uptake to a launch email, and I built the Manager Guide myself on Amazon Q Developer in one week against a months-long path. I measured active usage rather than headcount with access and reported that to senior leaders.
- **Cleared Risk, Compliance, and Legal without stalling the build:** Prototyped and pressure-tested first, then brought them in to set hard limits once it was worth building. No client data or PII was allowed to be entered into the platform, no AI-initiated actions, and guided prompts kept the person in control of every decision.

Networks, Recognition, and Operating Discipline

- **Built one operating model across seven business areas:** Connected them through named liaisons, shared strategy, and peer learning, and set the operating rhythm, prioritization, and resource decisions that kept it running.
- **Ran the Client Services recognition program for a decade (2014-2025):** Built it into TIAA's largest, sending 34% of all recognitions company-wide in 2021 on 306% year-over-year growth in associates recognized. Built and negotiated a \$300K annual engagement budget within roughly \$500K in total recognition spend administered. That record earned a seat on the corporate RFP team, where I helped write the RFP, scored vendor proposals, and stayed through the new platform's company-wide launch.
- **Built and ran the Skills of the Future curriculum with a team of 7:** Five tracks of 12 to 17 modules on future, digital-first, and AI skills. 890 associates engaged, a subset audience rather than a company-wide program.
- **Led workplace modernization across six locations (2022-2024):** Owned change strategy and the champion network through return-to-office, the Denver consolidation (44% footprint reduction), and the Frisco Corporate Center opening.

Product Manager, Sales Engineer, Information Architect

2001 - 2011

Interactive Media / FT Knowledge / Pearson Performance Solutions / Vangent

A decade delivering to Fortune 500 clients, both services engagements and the implementation and support of platforms those clients licensed.

- **Worked directly with Fortune 500 customers:** Unilever, Bank of America, Verizon Wireless, GE Capital, Royal Bank of Canada, and Regions Bank. Scoped capability needs, ran client sessions, and shaped multi-year implementation plans.
- **Product-managed three automated recruiting solutions:** Deployed for the U.S. Department of Commerce 2010 Census and Extra Space Storage. Field-driven enhancements cut client hiring costs 50-80% and speed-to-hire in half.

CAPABILITIES

Enablement & Change: Champion Networks & Communities of Practice | Self-Paced Curriculum Design | Role-Based Enablement & Playbooks | Recognition Program Design & Vendor Selection | Change Communications | Executive Read-Outs & QBRs

AI Agents: Multi-Agent Delegation Design | Output Evaluation & Review Gates | Prompt Architecture | AI-Directed Build | Responsible AI Governance

AI Platforms, Hands-On: Claude and Claude Code (daily) | Microsoft 365 Copilot | ChatGPT | Amazon Q Developer and Kiro (at TIAA) | GitHub Copilot

Operating & Domain: Operating Model Design | Use-Case Prioritization | Adoption Measurement (active use, not access) | Lean | Regulated Financial Services, 15 years | Learning Technology (LCMS, LMS) | SharePoint Governance

EDUCATION & RECOGNITION

M.S. Instructional Technology, Bloomsburg University, PA (4.0 GPA) | **B.A. Art,** Millersville University, PA

Certifications: Google Generative AI for Leaders | Lean for Financial Services, TIAA (inaugural class)

Recognition: Three-time TIAA Values Champion (2022, 2025, 2026) | Change Champion (2025) | Face of TIAA Values VIP, one of four individuals recognized that month (2025)